

“O’ flowers that still live in watercolor”

i am the sole inflictor of deforestation

i.

unsheathe yourself with layers of raw pink, glistening scarlet and sour in the summer sun
beige landscapes cracked; expose pure sky
so blindingly blue! what if i could have told
all the expanse that curdles within
would it purify me, to drain? would i be lessened?

ii.

one lesson from my mother:
to not miss and to cry only to white tiles and cracked paint
orange-oil-spotted ceilings
cut down healthy trees and make room for old life
constantly bind back to the past, cross-reference
if we move on, will our future be real? will my future be worth?

iii.

once it was possible to stop hoping for the sky
pale hands, folding over the linings until the clouds imprint them silver
erudition until the definition of the planes underneath my skin is only a figure
twice taught from my mother and then over again by my father

a decimal is so small that it becomes grating noise in the back of a system's head
polluting the ground so roots grow in crooked with only the intention to survive, not succeed

iv.

here i stand with destructed forest in my mind and in frantic messages
on the yellow edge of a train platform
there will be things exchanged later
words either in eulogy or in prayer on a living room couch
tragedy so poignant that shakespeare would hang his own head where once mine paused
where once mine paused
where once mine paused
where once i paused

v.

a half cadence unresolved to the fifth
must eventually resolve to the first
in due time, this is what we dictate in theory
in theory we dictate the conservation of intelligent lands
in theory we dictate the regrowth of the grounds that once died
in theory i dictated my own dissolution
the absence of finding an answer

in practice,

I lived.

